

SONG INFORMATION *at a glance*

Song	Song summary	Age	Subject	Musical style
Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!	An upbeat and energetic introduction to the new season. Verse by verse it allows us to let go of all things winter, and to give a warm welcome to spring. A really singable, catchy song to get us all in the mood for celebration. <i>'Life is waking up!'</i> <i>NB: A signing video for this song is available with Words on Screen™</i>	5+	Spring; New life; Seasonal clothing; Dark/light days	Joyful
Full Of The Joys!	This 'happy-go-lucky' song is a perfect fit for the season, but one that is also well-suited to any upbeat or celebratory kind of day. The chorus comprises a variety of expressions that capture the feeling of being joyful. It is great for language work, and very hard to sing without smiling!	5+	Spring; Joy; Celebration	Joyful swing
A Perfect Day In Spring	Light and breezy, feel-good and carefree, this song seeks to capture the spirit of the season. The chorus encourages us to engage all our senses to fully appreciate the joy of spring. The simple two-part singing helps bring it all together. <i>'Could there be a better time of year?'</i>	5+	PSHE; Spring	Light and breezy
Songbird	We couldn't have a spring collection without including the songbirds! Inspired one morning by a beautiful blackbird, this song seeks, verse by verse, to answer the question 'What could the message be to his song?' With its light and jazzy feel, we hope everyone will be encouraged to sing along. <i>NB See our wonderful craft video making songbird hand puppets to 'sing' along. www.outoftheark.co.uk/sfe-spring-assembly</i>	7+	Songbirds; Nature; Spring	Jazz swing
Caterpillar Munch	A song for younger voices, this follows the caterpillar as he fattens himself up on his journey to butterfly freedom. The vocal arrangement on the recording mirrors his growth from one verse to the next – from duet, to group, to ensemble.	5+	Caterpillars; Science; Nature	Electronic caterpillary fun
April Showers	A song of four simple, easy-to-perform parts, that build and overlay. It's great fun hearing all the parts come together, and good for listening and holding individual melodies. Create the arrival and fading of a seasonal shower, and enjoy the changes of dynamic along the way.	5+	Rain; Weather	Descriptive raindrop percussion
It's A Spring Thing!	Definitely a song to make you smile! With a cumulative chorus, highly descriptive verses and a really fun harmony echo, there's plenty here to enjoy. Clarity of diction will only enhance the satisfaction of singing the rhymes and alliteration: <i>'It's an all-things beautiful, feeling kinda musical, spring thing!'</i>	5+	Spring; Happiness	Jazz swing with a nod to barbershop

All the songs in this book are teachable by anyone and everyone. If you have no prior knowledge of music education, we recommend you start with a  graded music activity which will help you begin to open up the musical possibilities within the songs. You'll soon realize there's nothing to be scared of! The following key, shown on each activity page, will help give an indication of how confident you can be in delivering the given activity:

 no prior musical knowledge required

 some basic knowledge of rhythm or notation may be helpful

 a reasonable grasp of music fundamentals would be an advantage

Vocal range	Key	Musical elements	Music activity	Inter-related dimensions
Large (C-D)	C	• Syncopation • Melodic leaps • Chromatic passages	Explore musical 'mood' by learning about tonality and playing scales in major and minor keys. Step this up a level by composing simple winter or spring songs.	
Medium (C-C)	A ^b	• Syncopation • Melodic variation	Notice the melodic variation in the chorus and listen to examples of other themes and variations. Create your own variation by changing one or more of the notes of the melody, using tuned percussion instruments or keyboards.	  
Large (B-C)	G	• Vocal leaps • Part-singing • Melodic sequences	Create a graphic score and use this to explore musical sounds, textures, tempo and dynamics. Play your composition together as an ensemble following your graphic score.	  
Large (B-D)	E-F	• Syncopation • Modulation • Vocal leaps	Use listening skills to define and recognize different timbres in birdsong and create musical motifs to simulate these on percussion instruments. Then, work as a group to improvise a brilliant birdsong composition!	   
Medium (C-C)	C	• Duet/group opportunities • Vocal leaps	Learn about beat and pulse as you march, creep and crawl in time to the music. Then, use listening skills to identify how certain musical timbres can create sound effects and imagery, creating musical stories.	   
Medium (C-C)	F	• Part-singing • Dynamic/texture changes • Scope for body percussion and choreography	A chance to explore and improvise raindrop sound effects using percussion instruments and body percussion. This activity also provides a great opportunity for discussing texture, timbre and dynamics as the four parts gradually enter and then stop, representing the passing shower.	  
Large (C-C#) (Harmony C-D#)	F-F#	• Cumulative lyrics • Harmony-singing • Echoes • Modulation • Articulation	Compose and perform a 'spoken chorus' or rap using lyrical phrases from <i>It's A Spring Thing!</i>	  

Icon Key



Dynamics



Pitch



Rhythm/duration



Structure



Timbre



Texture



Tempo



Notation



Articulation

SONG INFORMATION *at a glance*

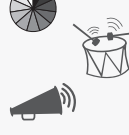
Song	Song summary	Age	Subject	Musical style
As The Sun Rises	A song of faith and gratitude to welcome any new day with hope and positivity. Focusing on the goodness of God, and our daily response to His love, this is a song of praise for any assembly. With fabulous harmonies and a contagious chorus, this is a song to lift our spirits. <i>'As the sun rises on a new day, may our hearts say, "God is good to us"'</i> . <i>NB: A signing video for this song is available with Words on Screen™</i>	7+	RE; Worship; Positivity; Love	Pop with momentum
Because It's Springtime!	A simple song with plenty of repetition and bounce, which make this perfect for younger voices. Explore and enjoy the signs of spring and celebrate 'every little thing' that 'has started coming to life!' <i>NB: A signing video for this song is available with Words on Screen™</i>	5+	Spring; Nature; New life	Bright and bouncy swing
The Tadpole Song	Meet Tod, the very anxious tadpole. A song-story that follows his nervous journey, and celebrates his remarkable transformation. Huge scope for harmonies, performance and choreography. Enjoy the big finale chorus, complete with full-on New Orleans jazz band. A helpful reminder for the 'tadpole' in us all: <i>'Things'll work out all right!'</i>	5+	Frogs; Life cycles; Science; PSHE	With a swing (and full-on New Orleans jazz)
We're Making Pancakes	Fun to sing, great to perform and even better to eat! This positive song has a real feel-good factor, with scope for layers of sweet harmonies. Watch out for the sneaky modulation into the final verse, and remember... <i>'Don't put too much sugar on the top!'</i> Go to www.outoftheark.co.uk/sfe-spring-assembly to see our dance video for this song.	5+	Pancakes; Shrove Tuesday; Food	Jazz shuffle
You're The Best Mum For Me!	What better way to show our appreciation to mums everywhere, than with a song of gratitude and celebration. A simple song with a simple message: <i>'You're the best mum for me!'</i>	5+	Mother's Day; Gratitude; Celebration; Love	Upbeat
Sing Yourself A Happy Song	This song, in three parts, has a practical application: <i>'to make the job a bit easier'</i> . A great excuse to sing together, and huge fun.	5+	PSHE; Happiness; Productivity	Joyful
Ring Out The Bells! (We're Coming Alive)	If you're looking for a BIG song for a special Easter celebration, look no further! This modern-day hymn (with screaming guitar) explores the significance of the Resurrection, and encourages all believers to <i>'shout it from the rooftops, Jesus is alive!'</i> The closing section features both harmonies and a big crescendo finish. Enjoy!	7+	Easter; RE; Resurrection; Eternal life	Anthemic
He Is Risen (Easter Blessing)	A song of blessing and declaration for Easter assemblies and services. Part-singing and harmonies are also included. A fitting end, perhaps, to this unique collection of spring celebration songs.	5+	Easter; Spring; Love; Hope; Joy	Joyful and positive

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Vocal range	Key	Musical elements	Music activity	Inter-related dimensions
Large (Bb-D)	G	• Modulation • Harmony-singing • Syncopation	Investigate the use of drones/pedal notes in music and work with a partner to compose a simple melody to play over the top of a drone.	
Large (B-C#)	E	• Syncopation • Melodic leaps	Explore the tresillo rhythm by clapping along with and moving to the backing track. Listen to some examples in other pieces of music and then transfer this rhythm to untuned percussion instruments to create a rhythmic accompaniment to the verses.	
Small (C-Bb) (Harmony (C-D)	F	• Solo opportunities • Harmony-singing • Tempo changes	Listen to how Saint-Saëns uses sound imagery to depict the animals in his composition <i>Carnival of the Animals</i> , then, in groups, compose some musical animal stories.	
Large (B-D)	E-F	• Modulation • Harmony-singing • Scope for choreography	Compose a cool jazz-club-style accompaniment to the song using rhythms learned from the song lyrics.	
Large (B-B)	G	• Scale passages • Chromaticism	Explore rests in music and have fun with some call-and-response rhythms.	
Large (B-D#)	A	• Part-singing • Melodic leaps • Syncopation	Have fun learning about musical intervals with this musical ladders activity.	
Large (B-C#)	E	• Dynamic build • Syncopation • Scale passages	Using the idea of peeling bells, explore scale passages, playing in groups and in a round.	
Large (B-D)	D	• Solo opportunities • Group-singing • Harmony-singing • $\frac{6}{8}$ time signature	Explore the compound time signature of this song using stamping, clapping, patting, tapping and clicking fingers!	

Icon Key

 Dynamics

 Pitch

 Rhythm/duration

 Structure

 Timbre

 Texture

 Tempo

 Notation

 Articulation